

today is a reinvention of traditional silhouettes. For example, the dhoti is versatile and can be adapted to different body shapes. While younger people might wear it with a ganji and older people can team it with a kurti, plumper women can experiment with the dhoti skirt," she adds.

Saluja's stylistically experimental collection Bu-shirt Meets Dhoti might not be for the woman on the street, but there's no denying his love affair with drapes and textures as he reinvents the drop-crotch look. "Drapes

have always been a part of our heritage, whether it's the sari, dhoti or lungi. Besides the historical connection, there's also the comfort factor," says Saluja. Khanna too prefers to play around with silhouettes to cater to a wide variety of clients. "Global fashion trends are within our reach today," says Khanna, whose trademark clean cuts showed up on a flattering

variety of churi pants, jodhpurs and wide-bottomed pants in her spring-summer line.

And with the straight wide-bottomed hem making a comeback there's more than enough room for

experimentation, literally.

Designer and revivalist Anuradha

Vakil says she's been designing wide-bottomed trousers for the last

10 years and will still be doing them in the next decade.

"The idea is to look at the past with a fresh eye and interpret it using your own design idiom, making it relevant to today's fashion," she adds, all set to reintroduce Bollywood to the traditional wide-legged izaar with Sonam Kapoor's vintage makeover in *Saawariya*.

But not every catwalk trend is worth blindly copying, as most designers will attest. While Narendra Kumar Ahmed's women donned high-waist pants and even jodhpurs on the runways, the designer offers a word of caution. "High waist pants lengthen the silhouette and look good on women whose waist to hip ratio is not too disparate," he says.

The biggest trend this season also proves to be the biggest bone of contention as many couturiers say the jodhpur should be let out of the closet sparingly by women. While Ahmed says jodhpurs work for tall women, Tawadey is unequivocal in her disapproval. "High-waists can be worn by women with bodies like Cameron Diaz, and jodhpurs for women are just a passing fad, only fit for the runway." However, Khanna prefers to call them "trendy". "These are clothes that are usually for people with certain style who can carry them off. Jodhpurs are not for everybody," she explains.

And even as skirts dress up in cowls, bubbles, volume, origami folds and asymmetric hemlines with elasticised bottoms, many of fall and spring's catwalk trends are far from fitting into the Indian woman's wardrobe. But why experiment with garments that don't score too high on the wearability meter? Saluja believes fashion is about testing and trying. "Unless we push the envelope how will we know if it works," he says. And if it works, in time the trend

- will definitely trickle down to the streets, a testament of its sartorial success. So even if slim pants stand the chance of replacing churidars in
- many wardrobes, the Jodhpur is far from making it to every woman's must-buy list. Younger women today are experimenting with gauchos, Thai pants, harem pants and the like. But even the most fashionable folks will tell you that style is ultimately about making something work for you and not blindly aping a trend. Because as Valaya warns, "The mirror never lies."



JODHPURS

These riding breeches are loose-fitting over the buttocks and thighs, and tight-fitting from knee to calf, as seen here in Gayatri Khanna's interpretation.

HIGH WAIST PANTS

The newest jeans trend combines the slim fit concept with a high waist in a '70s comeback, as seen on the Levi's catwalk.